Preface to the Fifth Edition

The comprehensive revision of this book is in the light of the growing sales and encouraging feedback from the readers. I am indebted to all those who have sent mails, some appreciative, some critical, some constructive. Based on all the suggestions and feedback, I am delighted to place before you the *Fifth Edition* of the book, fully revised and with *three new chapters* that address the concerns of government policy-making.

The Doha Round of the WTO lapsed in December 2012, ending the first and 'most ambitious' organised attempt towards making a 'multilateral' world economic system possible. But the optimists are still hopeful – that the Round may get 'revived' at the next Conference in Bali, December 2014. President Obama's re-election and his focus to revive the US economy, the situation of countries like Greece, France, Ireland, in the Euro zone are some of the other major global economic concerns.

Meanwhile, India is beset with its own economic woes, much of it due to policy paralysis, weak governance and lack of transparent laws and favourable investment climate. It recorded the lowest growth rate of the decade, due to a combination of national and international factors, including a poor monsoon. The new edition has focused on these areas and attempts to provide an analysis of these issues in a lucid manner.

The Three new Chapters included are (i) *Technology-Environment Dilemma; (ii) Sustainability and Climate Change*, and (iii) *Preparing for the Demographic Dividend*. These address contemporary concerns of the economic situation.

The Chapter *Model Answers* to Selected Questions has been revised and updated with *20 more Model Answers* included. This follows long pending demand from our readers.

Chapters like *Inflation & Business Cycle, Financial Market, Banking, Security Market , Tax Structure* and *Public Finance* etc have been revamped.